



On the 20th of May, there is an industry talk by Mr. Zaid Waqi Zulkifli from Telekom Malaysia. It was an insightful session that has provided a clear understanding of the complexities of enterprise data systems. The session highlighted that real-world data architecture is often more complicated and unpredictable compared to what is usually learned in the classroom. Through his sharing, it was understood that enterprise systems are not always neat or simple, as large organizations need to manage many different systems, processes, departments and business requirements at the same time.

One of the key points learned from the session was that business changes faster than systems. Businesses continue to evolve due to new products, customer demands, regulations, competition and acquisitions. However, enterprise data systems usually require more time to be updated and maintained. This creates challenges for data professionals, especially when they need to connect different systems and ensure that the data remains accurate, consistent, and useful for decision-making.

He explained too how a small business like selling nasi lemak can start with simple operations but become more complex as it grows. As the business expands, more systems and processes are needed to support sales, inventory, customers, suppliers and financial records. This shows how business growth can lead to a more complex data environment.

The session also introduced several enterprise systems commonly used by large companies, such as SAP, Oracle and HubSpot. From this, it was learned that technical skills alone are not enough in the industry. Besides knowing how to build systems or manage data pipelines, data engineers must also understand business operations and communicate effectively with clients or stakeholders.

Overall, this industry talk was meaningful because it connected technical knowledge with real business situations. It gave a more realistic view of how data and systems are managed in large enterprises. The session also motivated me to improve not only my technical skills, but also my communication, problem-solving and business understanding in order to be better prepared for industry.